

ETHIOSKILLS INTELLIGENCE

EthioSkills Intelligence Monthly Vacancy and Skill Report

Covers the 30 days up to 2026-10-01

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This report is produced and maintained independently by Mesfin Abraham Ali. Comments, corrections, proposals to share data, and collaboration or funding inquiries are welcome at mesfnism@gmail.com. The underlying pipeline is built to scale to additional vacancy sources, additional countries in the Horn of Africa, and partnerships with official statistical and labour market information bodies.

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Executive Summary

This month edition of EthioSkills Intelligence tracked 1905 vacancy postings across six Ethiopian job boards, standardized against international occupation, skills, education and industry taxonomies so that figures reported here are comparable across sources and over time. The purpose of this exercise is not to replace Ethiopia's official labour market information architecture, but to complement it. The national E-LMIS and the Ethiopian Statistical Service's household and establishment surveys provide periodic, authoritative but infrequent measurement of the labour market [1][3]. This report offers a continuously updated, narrower read of what employers are actually advertising for, close to real time.

The leading skill requested this period was **Communication**, the most active sector was **Professional, scientific and technical activities**, and the single largest identifiable hiring employer was **Bule Hora University**. This is the first snapshot recorded for this reporting cycle, so no week-on-week or month-on-month comparison is yet possible; subsequent editions of this report will carry trend comparisons as tracking history accumulates. The Analysis section below sets out these patterns in full, with supporting tables and figures; the Data Sources and Limitations sections set out, without qualification, what this exercise can and cannot yet claim to measure.



Introduction

Ethiopia's labour market is widely characterised, in both the academic and policy literature, by high youth unemployment, informality, and a persistent mismatch between the skills job seekers hold and the skills employers require [1][3]. A recurring theme in assessments of the country's labour market information architecture is fragmentation. Multiple institutions, including the Ministry of Labour and Skills, the Ethiopian Statistical Service, the Ethiopian Investment Commission, and programme offices funded by donors, each hold partial data collected administratively, with limited interoperability or routine sharing of data between them [1][2]. Ethiopia's own E-LMIS initiative, evolving through systems including Ethioworks and JEDI, is a direct institutional response to this gap, but remains a work in progress [1][2].

EthioSkills Intelligence takes a narrower, complementary approach. Rather than attempting to measure the labour market as a whole, it tracks what is observable directly and continuously, namely vacancy postings advertised on Ethiopia's most used online job boards. Each posting is read, structured, and classified against four international standards. ESCO for skills, ISCO-08 for occupations, ISCED 2011 for education levels, and ISIC Rev.4 for industry sectors [4][5][6][7]. This makes a posting's requirements comparable across sources and legible to anyone already familiar with those schemes, including statistical agencies and development partners.

This month report covers covers the 30 days up to 2026-10-01. It is one of two companion editions produced on a rolling basis. A weekly edition captures short-term movement, and a monthly edition captures a steadier baseline. Both are generated automatically from the same underlying dataset and published alongside a live, continuously updated dashboard.

Scope and methodology, briefly

Six sources are tracked. EthioJobs, HaHuJobs, Ethiopian Reporter Jobs, PalmJobs, DevNetJobs (filtered to postings relevant to Ethiopia) and HarmeeJobs. A posting that has been cross posted to more than one source is identified and merged rather than double counted, matched on employer, job title and location within a short window around the posting date. Each of the four taxonomies above is applied independently per field. A posting that cannot be confidently classified against a given taxonomy is excluded from that specific breakdown rather than guessed at, and is still counted toward overall volume. The Data Sources section that follows sets out what each source does and does not capture well. The Limitations section sets out what this leaves unresolved.

Data Sources

Each source below is described in terms of what it covers, what it is reliably good for, where it currently falls short, and what a realistic next step to improve it looks like. None of the sources is treated as authoritative on its own. The value of combining them is in triangulating signal across boards that would otherwise sit in isolation from each other, in the same spirit recommended for Ethiopia's wider system of labour market information [1].

EthioJobs

Scope. Ethiopia's largest general job board, spanning private companies, banks, manufacturers, schools and some NGOs.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is the largest and steadiest volume of any single source tracked here, with structured fields (career level, education, years of experience, required skills) read directly from each posting's detail page rather than inferred.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that postings rarely state a wage figure, so salary coverage for this source alone is thin, and a posting written only in Amharic is not yet parsed into the skills, education or sector classifiers.

Possible improvement. extending the skills and category classifiers to Amharic text, and cross-checking a sample of postings against the employer's own site for wage information where available.

HaHuJobs

Scope. A second major Ethiopian job board, covering a mix of employers similar to EthioJobs in the private sector, with heavier representation from public institutions and universities.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is job descriptions written as free text that, unlike EthioJobs, often let the field of study and salary classifiers extract a specific value rather than only a coarse category.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that a meaningful share of its postings from the public sector and universities are written entirely in Amharic, which the current classifiers cannot read. Those postings count toward total volume but not toward the Skills, Education or Sector breakdowns.

Possible improvement. extending language coverage to Amharic, the same fix planned for EthioJobs, would recover this gap directly, since the underlying postings already exist in the tracked data.

Ethiopian Reporter Jobs

Scope. The vacancy section of an Ethiopian weekly newspaper that has run for many years. It carries a distinct mix of postings, with a larger share of public sector and NGO notices than the job boards that operate purely online.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is being independent of the online job boards, so it surfaces vacancies, particularly notices from public institutions, that may not be posted anywhere else.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that the site runs bot detection that can intermittently block an automated browser. As of this report its tracked volume is noticeably thinner than the other sources. This is a known and acknowledged gap rather than a silent one (see Limitations).

Possible improvement. a fix to the browser's fingerprint has already been applied. Confirming it holds across multiple scheduled runs, and adding an alert when a run returns zero postings, are the next concrete steps.

PalmJobs

Scope. A newer Ethiopian job board drawing on a modern web stack, covering a mix of employers broadly similar to EthioJobs and HaHuJobs in the private sector.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is structured data read directly from the site's own API, giving clean fields with little parsing of free text required once the connection to that API is working.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that the site has changed its own technical architecture more than once since tracking began, each time silently breaking the pipeline's connection to it until corrected. Its tracked volume is currently thinner than it should be as a result.

Possible improvement. a fix that reads the site's own public API key directly from its code has been applied. The next scheduled runs will show whether it restores full coverage, and a lightweight daily check, asking whether this source returned zero postings today, is planned to catch the next such change quickly.

DevNetJobs

Scope. An international vacancy board for the development sector. This pipeline filters it to postings relevant to Ethiopia only, using a keyword search, so it is deliberately narrower than the general job boards.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is a distinct slice of the market oriented toward international work, donor roles, NGO roles and development programme roles, that general job boards rarely carry.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that resolving a listing into its full detail page depends on replaying the site's own interactive behaviour, which is fragile by nature, and a share of its postings are visible to members only and are correctly skipped rather than guessed at. Both factors currently keep its tracked volume very low. As of this report, it is effectively a single posting.

Possible improvement. the pipeline now drives that interaction through a real browser page rather than approximating it, which should recover most postings that were previously missed, on the next run. If volume stays low after that, the keyword search itself, currently scoped narrowly to avoid noise from listings visible only to members, is the next thing to widen.

HarmeeJobs

Scope. An Ethiopian job board read via its own public RSS feed rather than by parsing rendered HTML.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is the cleanest and most stable connection of any source tracked here, since an RSS feed is a stable, structured contract that a site redesign is unlikely to break.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that an RSS feed typically carries less structured detail per posting than a full detail page, so some fields (years of experience, a specific salary figure) are stated less often here than for sources read from full detail pages.

Possible improvement. where the feed links back to a full posting page, fetching that page for the subset of fields it still lacks is a natural next step.

Separately from coverage at the source level, this period's data also shows thin coverage on fields that depend on a posting stating them explicitly. Fewer than 50 percent of postings report stating a clear monthly pay figure, stating a clear education level. This is a property of what employers choose to disclose, not a parsing failure, and it is treated as a stated limitation throughout rather than estimated or imputed.

Analysis

Skills in demand

Table 1. Top skills explicitly requested, month window.

#	Skill (ESCO-normalized)	Postings
1	Communication	520
2	Problem solving	188
3	Attention to detail	182
4	Teamwork	112
5	Accounting	102
6	Decision-making	68
7	Creativity	42
8	Leadership	38
9	Coordination	36
10	Analytical thinking	31

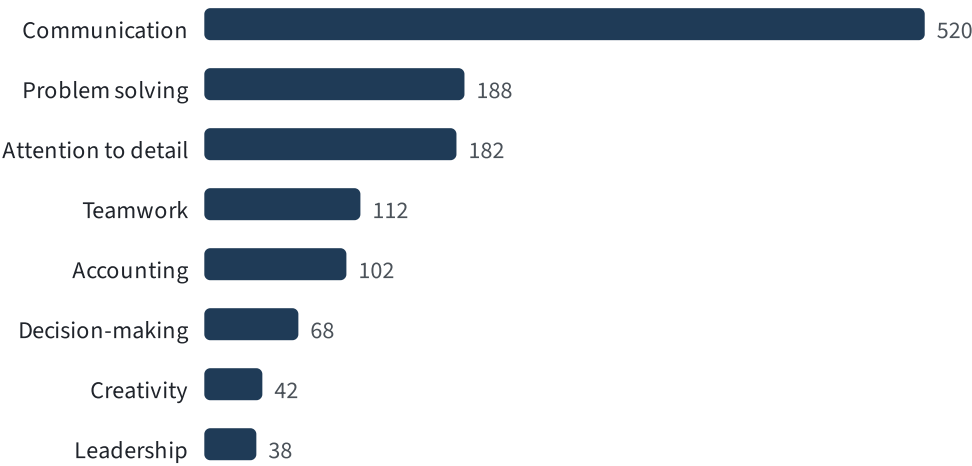


Figure 1. Posting counts for the top requested skills, month window.

Where those skills matter, sectoral patterns

Skill demand is not uniform across the economy. The sector a posting sits in shapes which specific skill is most sought after within it. Table 2 reports, for each of the most active sectors this period, the single skill most frequently requested within postings tagged to that sector, subject to a minimum of three postings in that sector stating explicit skills, so that a one-off posting is never reported as a sector's standard.

Table 2. Most active sectors and each sector's single most-requested skill, month window.

Sector (ISIC Rev.4)	Postings	Leading skill in this sector
Professional, scientific and technical activities	765	Communication
Financial and insurance activities	262	Communication
Education	222	Communication
Human health and social work activities	185	Communication
Accommodation and food service activities	140	Communication
Transportation and storage	120	Communication
Wholesale and retail trade	108	Communication
Information and communication	81	Communication

Education, experience and pay profile

Of 1905 postings this period, 594 (31.2%) state a clear education requirement, 1490 (78.2%) state years of experience required, and only 61 (3.2%) state a clear monthly pay figure. This is consistent with the broader observation that Ethiopian employers disclose compensation far less often than qualifications.

Persistent and emerging patterns

Comparing this period against the closest available prior snapshot distinguishes demand that is structurally embedded in the market from demand that is newly rising or fading. A single snapshot on its own cannot make that distinction.

No prior snapshot is yet available far enough back to compare against, so this edition reports levels rather than change. Persistence and emergence will be reported from the next cycle in which a comparable baseline exists.

Advantages, Limitations and Planned Improvements

Advantages of this approach

- Continuous, low cost measurement that refreshes automatically, in contrast to periodic labour market information based on surveys that updates on a multi-year cycle.
- Standardized against the same international taxonomies (ESCO, ISCO-08, ISCED 2011, ISIC Rev.4) used in official reporting on labour markets, so figures here are directly comparable to other work using the same schemes.
- Full transparency on what is and is not captured. A field that cannot be classified confidently is excluded from that breakdown rather than estimated, and every honesty threshold used in this report (for example a minimum posting count before a most-requested skill is reported for a group) is stated rather than hidden.

Limitations

- Coverage is restricted to vacancies advertised on the specific online boards tracked. Informal, word of mouth, and unadvertised hiring, a substantial share of actual hiring activity in Ethiopia, is not observed at all.
- Classification currently works on text written in English. A meaningful share of postings, particularly from public institutions, are written in Amharic and are not yet classified into the Skills, Education or Sector breakdowns, though they are still counted toward overall volume.
- Employer type (Private, Public or NGO) is inferred from a keyword heuristic on the employer's own name, not a verified registry lookup, and should be read as indicative.
- Tracked history is still short relative to the seasonal cycles a labour market can exhibit over a full year. Early trend comparisons should be read cautiously until more history accumulates.

In this edition specifically, coverage is thin for stating a clear education level (31.2% of postings), stating a clear monthly pay figure (3.2% of postings). Three of the six tracked sources, Ethiopian Reporter Jobs, PalmJobs and DevNetJobs, are also currently contributing fewer postings than their true listing volume, for the technical reasons specific to each source set out on the Data Sources page. Fixes for each have been applied and their effect is being confirmed over the next few scheduled runs.

Planned improvements

Near-term priorities are extending the language coverage of the skills and sector classifiers to Amharic text, closing the volume gap on the three sources that currently fall short, and adding additional sources, including, subject to feasibility and permission, sources beyond Ethiopia's borders within the Horn of Africa. Readers who hold data, funding, or institutional mandate relevant to any of these priorities are invited to make contact (see the cover page for details).

Conclusion

Over this month window, Ethiopia's tracked online vacancy market continued to concentrate around a recognisable core of skill and sector demand, led by Communication as the single most requested skill and Professional, scientific and technical activities as the most active sector. This concentration, together with the persistence observed across reporting periods for a recurring set of top skills and sectors, is consistent with a labour market in which demand is structurally embedded in a small number of sectors and roles rather than shifting unpredictably from one period to the next. That pattern itself has implications for how training providers and jobseekers might prioritise their effort.

At the same time, the gaps documented in this report, thin wage disclosure, uneven coverage across sources, and a language barrier on postings written only in Amharic, mean that this report's picture of the market, while directionally useful, remains partial. It is offered as a complement to, not a substitute for, Ethiopia's official labour market information systems, and is intended to improve in coverage and depth with each future edition.

Recommendations

For training providers and TVET institutions

Align curriculum updates with the skills and sectors shown as persistent in this report's Analysis section, since persistence across reporting periods is a stronger signal of durable demand than a single period's figures alone. Where a specific sector's leading skill (Table 2) differs from what a programme currently emphasises, that gap is worth investigating directly with employers in that sector.

For policymakers and labour market information stakeholders

This report's granularity at the sector and skill level, refreshed continuously, is offered as a complementary input to the periodic measurement based on surveys that Ethiopia's official labour market information architecture already produces, and as a concrete example of the kind of administrative data integration recommended in prior assessments of that architecture [1]. Collaboration on sharing data, validation against official sources, or integration into E-LMIS reporting is welcomed.

For jobseekers

The Top Skills table and the tables of leading skill by sector in this report (Analysis section) are a practical starting point for prioritising which skills to acquire or present, particularly where a skill appears as both persistent and leading in its sector rather than a one-off spike.

Scaling and collaboration

The underlying pipeline is built to extend to further sources, further geographies within the Horn of Africa, and partnership with institutional initiatives in labour market information or ones funded by donors. Readers interested in collaboration, sharing data, or funding this work are invited to make contact (see the cover page for details).

References

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8. Primary vacancy data. EthioJobs (ethiojobs.net), HaHuJobs (hahu.jobs), Ethiopian Reporter Jobs (ethiopianreporterjobs.com), PalmJobs (palmjobs.et), DevNetJobs (devnetjobs.org, filtered to Ethiopia) and HarmeeJobs, scraped and standardized daily by the author's own open pipeline (github.com, EthioJobs Tracker project).